

BANARAS HINDU UNIVERSITY

B.A. (Hons.) Semester IV Examination, 2025-26 (NEP)

A.I.H.C. & ARCHAEOLOGY

Paper Code: AIHMN-41 : Political Ideas and Institutions of Ancient India

Time: 2:30 Hours

Full Marks: 70

Instructions: Attempt all questions. Questions of Sections A, B and C carry 10, 05 and 02 marks each.

: - , 10, 05 02

SECTION A / -

(Long Answer Type Questions /)

Note: Attempt all questions. Answer each question in approximately 250 words. Each question carries 10 marks.

: 250 10

Question 1. Critically examine the different theories of the origin of the State in Ancient India.

[10]

OR /

Discuss the Saptanga theory of the State and explain its components in detail.

[10]

Question 2. Analyse the role of republican traditions in Ancient India and assess their political significance.

[10]

OR /

Examine the system of inter-state relations and diplomacy in Ancient India with reference to Mandala theory and espionage.

- [10]

Question 3. Discuss the administrative system of the Mauryas with special reference to central and provincial administration.

, [10]

OR /

Discuss the administrative features of the Chola dynasty with special emphasis on local self-government.

, [10]

SECTION B / -

(Short Answer Type Questions /)

Note: Attempt all questions. Answer each question in approximately 125-150 words. Each question carries 05 marks.

: 125-150 05

Question 4. Explain the nature and scope of the State in Ancient Indian thought.

[5]

Question 5. Discuss the origin and development of the concept of Kingship in Ancient India.

[5]

Question 6. Examine the composition and functions of the Sabha and Samiti in Ancient India.

[5]

Question 7. Write a short note on the administrative features of the Gupta dynasty.

[5]

OR /

Discuss the administrative system of the Rashtrakutas in brief.

[5]

SECTION C / -

(Very Short Answer Type Questions /)

Note: Write very short notes on the following, each in about 15-20 words. Each question carries 02 marks.

: 15-20 02

Question 8.

(a) What is meant by the State?

?

[2]

(b) Explain the meaning of the term 'Yogakshema'.

,

[2]

- (c) Identify the source of the Sanskrit passage “*Svamyamatya janapadadurgakosadandamitraprakrtayah*”.
“ ” [2]
- (d) Name the important elements (limbs) mentioned in the Rigveda.
/ [2]
- (e) State the source of the verse: “*Prajasukhe sukham rajnah prajanam ca hite hitam*”.
“ ” [2]
- (f) What is meant by Vairajya? Briefly explain.
“ ” ? [2]
- (g) What are the types of victory described in Ancient Indian texts?
-- ? [2]
- (h) What is Matsyanyaya?
? [2]
- (i) What is Danda in Ancient Indian polity?
“ ” ? [2]
- (j) Define Purushartha.
[2]